Northwind Analytics Employee Handbook

Revised January 2026

1. Welcome

This handbook describes the policies and benefits that apply to all regular employees of Northwind Analytics. It is not a contract of employment. Where local law provides a greater benefit than this handbook, local law applies. Questions about any policy should go to your manager or to People Operations at people@northwind.example.

2. Working hours

Standard working hours are 40 hours per week. Core collaboration hours are 10:00 to 15:00 in your local time zone; outside core hours you may arrange your schedule with your manager. Overtime for non-exempt employees is paid at 1.5 times the base hourly rate for hours over 40 in a week.

3. Code of conduct

We expect every employee to act with integrity, treat colleagues with respect, and protect customer data. Harassment of any kind is not tolerated. Concerns can be raised with any manager, with People Operations, or anonymously through the ethics hotline. Retaliation against anyone who raises a concern in good faith is prohibited.

4. Confidentiality

Customer data, source code, financial results and product plans are confidential. Do not share them outside the company or with colleagues who do not need them for their work. Confidentiality obligations continue after employment ends.

5. Equipment and workspace

Every employee receives a company laptop and may choose a monitor, keyboard and headset from the approved catalogue. In addition, each employee receives a one-time equipment allowance of $500 in their first month to furnish a home workspace, for items such as a desk, a chair or lighting. Receipts must be submitted within 60 days. Equipment purchased with the allowance belongs to the employee.

6. Expenses

Reasonable business expenses are reimbursed when submitted with receipts within 30 days. Travel must be booked through the company travel tool. Meals while travelling are reimbursed up to $75 per day.

7. Paid time off

New employees receive 15 days of paid vacation in their first year of employment, accruing at 1.25 days per month from the start date. After three years of service the entitlement increases to 20 days per year, and after six years to 25 days. Up to 5 unused days may be carried into the following year; carried days must be used by March 31.

In addition to vacation, all employees receive 10 paid company holidays per year and 8 days of paid sick leave. Sick leave does not carry over.

Vacation requests of five or more consecutive days should be submitted at least four weeks in advance. Managers approve requests based on team coverage and will not unreasonably refuse.

8. Parental leave

Primary caregivers receive 16 weeks of fully paid parental leave; secondary caregivers receive 6 weeks. Leave may be taken within 12 months of the birth or adoption. Employees on parental leave continue to accrue vacation and remain eligible for the annual bonus on a pro-rated basis.

9. Health and retirement

The company pays 100% of the employee premium and 75% of dependent premiums for the standard medical, dental and vision plans. Employees may contribute to the 401(k) plan from their first paycheck; the company matches 100% of contributions up to 4% of salary, vesting immediately.

10. Performance and compensation

Performance reviews take place twice a year, in June and December. Compensation is reviewed annually in January. The annual bonus target is 10% of base salary for individual contributors and 15% for managers, paid in February based on company and individual performance.

11. Leaving the company

Employees are asked to give two weeks' notice. Unused accrued vacation is paid out on the final paycheck where required by local law. Company equipment must be returned within 10 days of the last working day; the equipment allowance purchases from section 5 are not returned.